

Manufacturing English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: plant managers, production supervisors, quality engineers, maintenance teams, industrial engineers, safety leads, supply planners, and manufacturing-adjacent professionals

Focus: A manufacturing English curriculum for production meetings, line problems, lean improvement, defects, maintenance, safety, supplier quality, shift handoffs, and root-cause communication.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Production Flow and Daily Management

Situation

A line misses target for the third shift in a row.

Stakeholder pressure: Ask operators to work faster.

Constraint: The constraint may be material availability, changeover time, staffing, or equipment reliability.

Terms to use

- throughput
- cycle time
- constraint
- downtime

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A line misses target for the third shift in a row.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ask operators to work faster.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects cycle time.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a daily production update.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects cycle time.

Option	Phrase
A	throughput
B	constraint
C	downtime
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Ask operators to work faster.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify throughput and cycle time against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
D	evidence threshold

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A line misses target for the third shift in a row. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the daily production update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 2. Lean, Waste, and Continuous Improvement

Situation

A kaizen event identifies excess movement and waiting.

Stakeholder pressure: Tell employees to be more efficient.

Constraint: Process design, layout, standard work, and visual management need review.

Terms to use

- kaizen
- standard work
- waste
- value stream

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A kaizen event identifies excess movement and waiting.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Tell employees to be more efficient.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects standard work.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a lean improvement proposal.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects standard work.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	kaizen
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Tell employees to be more efficient.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify kaizen and standard work against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A kaizen event identifies excess movement and waiting. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
B	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
C	evidence threshold
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the lean improvement proposal with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 3. Defects, Scrap, and Rework

Situation

Scrap has increased after a tooling change.

Stakeholder pressure: Ship the acceptable units and watch the trend.

Constraint: Containment, defect mode, inspection plan, and customer impact must be defined.

Terms to use

- defect
- scrap
- rework

- containment

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Scrap has increased after a tooling change.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ship the acceptable units and watch the trend.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects scrap.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a defect containment brief.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects scrap.

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	defect
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Ship the acceptable units and watch the trend.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	We should act now and resolve defect after the result is visible.
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify defect and scrap against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Scrap has increased after a tooling change. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the defect containment brief with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	decision owner

Option	Phrase
D	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.

Module 4. Root Cause and Corrective Action

Situation

A customer returns parts for fit issues.

Stakeholder pressure: Say the operator missed a step.

Constraint: Root cause must be supported by data, not assumed from the visible failure.

Terms to use

- root cause
- 5 Whys
- fishbone
- 8D

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A customer returns parts for fit issues.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Say the operator missed a step.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects 5 Whys.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a 8D problem statement.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects 5 Whys.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	root cause

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Say the operator missed a step.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify root cause and 5 Whys against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A customer returns parts for fit issues. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the 8D problem statement with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 5. Maintenance, Reliability, and Changeover

Situation

A critical machine keeps failing during peak demand.

Stakeholder pressure: Delay maintenance until the order is complete.

Constraint: Unplanned downtime, safety risk, spare parts, and preventive maintenance need balancing.

Terms to use

- preventive maintenance
- MTBF
- changeover
- spare parts

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A critical machine keeps failing during peak demand.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Delay maintenance until the order is complete.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects MTBF.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a maintenance risk escalation.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects MTBF.

Option	Phrase
A	changeover
B	spare parts
C	evidence threshold
D	preventive maintenance

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Delay maintenance until the order is complete.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify preventive maintenance and MTBF against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	evidence threshold
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A critical machine keeps failing during peak demand. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
B	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the maintenance risk escalation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 6. EHS and Safety Communication

Situation

A supervisor sees bypassed guarding during a rush order.

Stakeholder pressure: Finish the run and fix the guard later.

Constraint: Safety controls, lockout/tagout, and incident risk override schedule pressure.

Terms to use

- EHS
- lockout/tagout
- near miss

- stop work

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A supervisor sees bypassed guarding during a rush order.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Finish the run and fix the guard later.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects lockout/tagout.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a safety stop-work script.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects lockout/tagout.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	EHS

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Finish the run and fix the guard later.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify EHS and lockout/tagout against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A supervisor sees bypassed guarding during a rush order. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the safety stop-work script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	evidence threshold

Option	Phrase
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

Module 7. Supplier Quality and Incoming Materials

Situation

Incoming material fails inspection before a major build.

Stakeholder pressure: Use it because the supplier says it is fine.

Constraint: Specification, deviation approval, alternate supply, and customer risk must be assessed.

Terms to use

- supplier quality
- incoming inspection
- specification
- deviation

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Incoming material fails inspection before a major build.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Use it because the supplier says it is fine.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects incoming inspection.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a supplier deviation request.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects incoming inspection.

Option	Phrase
A	incoming inspection
B	supplier quality
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Use it because the supplier says it is fine.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	We should act now and resolve supplier quality after the result is visible.
B	A supplier deviation request is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
C	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify supplier quality and incoming inspection against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Incoming material fails inspection before a major build. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the supplier deviation request with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

Module 8. Shift Handoffs and Escalation

Situation

The night shift leaves an unresolved process alarm.

Stakeholder pressure: Let day shift figure it out.

Constraint: Handoff needs status, actions taken, risk, owner, and escalation path.

Terms to use

- handoff
- andon
- escalation
- owner

Three-step decision practice

Situation

The night shift leaves an unresolved process alarm.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Let day shift figure it out.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects andon.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a shift handoff note.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects andon.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	handoff
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Let day shift figure it out.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A shift handoff note is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify handoff and andon against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	We should act now and resolve handoff after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - The night shift leaves an unresolved process alarm. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
B	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the shift handoff note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	decision owner

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

Production Flow and Daily Management - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. throughput	'throughput' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Production Flow and Daily Management - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify throughput and cycle time against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Production Flow and Daily Management - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the daily production update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Lean, Waste, and Continuous Improvement - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. kaizen	'kaizen' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Lean, Waste, and Continuous Improvement - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify kaizen and standard work against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Lean, Waste, and Continuous Improvement - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the lean improvement proposal with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Defects, Scrap, and Rework - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. defect	'defect' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Defects, Scrap, and Rework - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify defect and scrap against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Defects, Scrap, and Rework - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the defect containment brief with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Root Cause and Corrective Action - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. root cause	'root cause' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Root Cause and Corrective Action - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify root cause and 5 Whys against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Root Cause and Corrective Action - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the 8D problem statement with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Maintenance, Reliability, and Changeover - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. preventive maintenance	'preventive maintenance' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Maintenance, Reliability, and Changeover - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify preventive maintenance and MTBF against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Maintenance, Reliability, and Changeover - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the maintenance risk escalation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

EHS and Safety Communication - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. EHS	'EHS' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

EHS and Safety Communication - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify EHS and lockout/tagout against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

EHS and Safety Communication - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the safety stop-work script with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Supplier Quality and Incoming Materials - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. supplier quality	'supplier quality' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Supplier Quality and Incoming Materials - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify supplier quality and incoming inspection against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Supplier Quality and Incoming Materials - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the supplier deviation request with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Shift Handoffs and Escalation - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. handoff	'handoff' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Shift Handoffs and Escalation - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify handoff and andon against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Shift Handoffs and Escalation - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the shift handoff note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.